

NICHATORN UPHONTIAN

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MSc Psychology graduate with a background in social entrepreneurship, experienced in designing and delivering wellbeing, community engagement, and social impact initiatives across Thailand, Japan, and the UK. Research interests in mental health, decentering, and rumination, alongside practical skills in behavioural research, stakeholder engagement, project management, and user-centred design. A track record of coordinating multidisciplinary teams and leading large-scale community projects, translating insights into meaningful experiences that increase participation and foster wellbeing. Passionate about applying psychology, behavioural science, and a human rights lens to build healthier, more connected communities and workplaces.

EDUCATION

MSc Psychology Conversion *Sep 2024 – Dec 2025*

University of Exeter, UK

- Dissertation: “The Role of Decentering in the Relationship Between Daily Mindfulness Practice and Rumination” — a cross-sectional online survey (Qualtrics/Prolific; n=283 UK adults aged 18–30) examining mindfulness, decentering and rumination using correlation and mediation analysis. Found decentering to be a key mechanism explaining the link between mindfulness and reduced rumination; research funded by the University of Exeter Psychology faculty.
- Developed skills in research design, ethics, survey development, participant recruitment, data cleaning, statistical analysis and clear communication of findings.

BA Global Studies & Social Entrepreneurship *Aug 2019 – Aug 2023*

School of Global Studies, Thammasat University, Thailand

- Multidisciplinary degree spanning sustainable development, urban studies and social enterprise, combined with extensive fieldwork, exchanges and community-based projects.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Front of House Team Member *Nov 2025 – Present*

Pho Restaurant, Exeter, UK (Part-time)

- Deliver attentive, efficient customer service in a fast-paced hospitality environment.
- Communicate clearly with customers and team members to ensure a smooth dining experience.
- Handle customer requests and resolve issues professionally and calmly.
- Build awareness of customer needs, service flow and experience quality in a high-volume setting.

Business Development Specialist *Apr 2024 – Jun 2024*

TGB, Thailand (Part-time, Hybrid)

- Developed and implemented B2B business strategies to drive growth and expand market presence.
- Created pitch decks and presented to stakeholders and potential business partners.
- Oversaw online marketplace campaigns and managed the company’s social media presence to boost brand awareness.

UNFCCC Event Assistant *Jul 2023*

Greater Mekong Subregion CCESP, Asian Development Bank, Bangkok, Thailand

- Assisted with event registration, ensuring smooth check-in for attendees of a regional climate policy dialogue.
- Facilitated communication among attendees, speakers and organisers to ensure seamless coordination.
- Took detailed notes on discussions related to climate change, disaster resilience and environmental sustainability.

Project Manager / Product Owner *Oct 2022 – Apr 2023*

Nang Lerng Immersive Exhibition, Bangkok, Thailand (Hybrid)

- Managed 30+ people across five cross-functional teams (Marketing, Media Production, Design, Logistics, Business Partner), plus 30 field staff.
- Organised six+ workshops and exhibitions, attracting 450+ attendees and generating over 29,250 THB (approx. £676) for the Nang Loeng community within one week.
- Grew the project’s Facebook following to 4,000 within 28 days and secured coverage in the Bangkok Post, The Standard, Urban Creature and Time Out Bangkok.

Fundraising Coordinator, Bangkok Design Week Jan 2023 – Feb 2023

Bangkok Design Week, Thailand (Hybrid)

- Supported local and international artists with the multimedia project “Why is the River Laughing?” at the historic So Heng Tai mansion, Talat Noi.
- Researched fundraising opportunities and supported installation, event staffing and workshop facilitation.
- Engaged with the local community to promote participation and increase project impact.

UX Design & Product Intern Jun 2021 – Jul 2021

Edsy.co, Bangkok, Thailand

- Conducted UX research, customer interviews and usability testing for a new application.
- Designed UI for blog and web pages, and built dynamic prototypes for the new application.
- Assisted with quarterly performance analysis using marketing metrics including CTR, conversion rate, ROI and CAC.

Researcher, Design Public Social Service Innovation Feb 2021 – May 2021

School of Global Studies, Thammasat University, Bangkok, Thailand

- Designed a public social service using the design-thinking process, in partnership with the local police department.
- Conducted ad-hoc and in-depth interviews and a community-based UX case study with locals, tourists and police officers.

Head Event Coordinator Nov 2019 – Jan 2020

Run2GetherxThammasat (with the Together Foundation)

- Led planning and coordination of an inclusive community running event promoting equal participation for people with disabilities.
- Coordinated volunteers, guide-runners and operations for 300+ attendees, supporting initiatives to challenge disability stigma and build community connection.

PROJECTS, WORKSHOPS & EXCHANGES

Moderator, Metaverse & Social Innovation Seminar (May 2022) — School of Global Studies, Thammasat University.

Chaired a discussion on the Metaverse and social enterprise with guest speakers from Fort and Vendii (Tao Bin).

TU-OCU International Exchange Program (Nov 2021 – Jan 2022) — Osaka University. Collaborated with Japanese students on place-branding research linking SDGs to local businesses in Japan and Thailand.

Manifesto for a Just City Workshop (Oct 2021) — TU Delft, Industrial Design Engineering. Took part in an international workshop on spatial justice and co-wrote a manifesto for a fairer, more inclusive city.

Sustainable Innovation Competition & Hackathon (Sep – Oct 2021) — Hackathon.com. Designed a human-centred website offering mental health support for carers during COVID-19 lockdowns.

International Girls in ICT Participant (Apr 2021) — International Telecommunication Union. Took part in a global day spotlighting opportunities for young women in ICT careers.

Global Engagement & Empowerment Forum (Feb 2021) — Yonsei University. Joined a forum on peace, prosperity and partnership for global cooperation and sustainable development.

Ethnographic Research Project (Researcher) (Jan – Mar 2020) — School of Global Studies, Thammasat University. Conducted community-based fieldwork in Ban Mon Khao Kaew village, Lampang, on local livelihoods and institutions.

SKILLS

Advocacy & Wellbeing: Mental health advocacy, human rights frameworks, disability inclusion & accessibility, psychological research methods

Research & Analysis: Qualitative & quantitative research, ethnographic fieldwork, UX research & testing, design thinking, statistical analysis (correlation & mediation)

Strategy & Communication: Business & marketing strategy, pitch decks & presentations, public speaking & facilitation, branding & social media

People & Community: Project & team leadership, event coordination, community engagement, customer service

Tools: Adobe XD, Microsoft Office & Excel, Qualtrics, prototyping tools

References: Available on request.